

Fire

Fire-making is a very ancient skill and one of the most important of the Stone Age. Once people started using fire, it provided many advantages. Fire helped people to keep warm, cook food, and to provide light for work in the evening.

Warmth

A warm fire is cozy and comforting to sit around, but for early humans this warmth would have been crucial for survival, especially in cold climates.

How people made fire

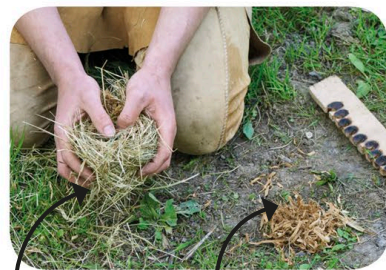
Early humans came across wild fires in forests, and then gradually learned how to make it themselves. One method of making fire using various handmade tools is called the bow drill.



The drill is a thick, pencil-shaped stick.

Step 1

A small nest from dried grass, called tinder, was made. Small pieces of dry wood, called kindling, were collected. These would be used to catch the first flame.



Nest of dried grass, called tinder

Small, dry sticks of wood, called kindling

